

Cruel Summer

After two consecutive years of rising rates, prices of home appliances are set to rise again this year

BY ARNAB DUTTA

► IF THE RECENT decline in inflation has got your hopes high, you may be in for a rude shock. Prices of white goods are not coming down anytime soon. In fact, the opposite is likely to happen. White goods makers, which have been steadily increasing their prices over the past two years, are likely to do so this year as well. Prices of consumer durables from ACs and refrigerators to smart TVs and washing machines are likely to go up. A further rise is expected in the second half of FY24 as the prospect of a normal

30
per cent
HIKE IN PRICES
OF LARGE-TICKET
CONSUMER
APPLIANCES SINCE
LATE 2020

monsoon is less assured.

Since late 2020, when the inflation cycle started, prices of large-ticket consumer appliances like ACs “have increased by more than 30 per cent”, says Kamal Nandi, Business Head and Executive Vice President at Godrej Appliances. “The costs had peaked in mid-2022 and since then we have observed some easing in the component prices. However, it is difficult to predict beyond the next three months because the situation remains uncertain.”

Another wave of price hikes is on the horizon, says Avneet Singh Marwah, CEO of Super Plastronics that makes and sells smart TVs under the Thomson and Kodak brands. “In the past four months, the prices of [LED] panels have surged by a whopping 30-35 per cent. We are planning to increase prices of TVs by 7-10 per cent from June,” he says.

However, AC company Blue Star is not in a mood to raise prices. It expects a

► **BENGALURU NOT** only occupies the top slot when it comes to high-street shopping destinations in India, the start-up capital also dominates the list with MG Road, Commercial Street, Brigade Road and Church Street making it to Knight Frank India’s annual top 10 retail streets in India.

While MG Road is on top, Soma-jiguda in Hyderabad, Linking Road in Mumbai and South Extension in Delhi occupy the next three spots, respectively, per the study—of 30 high streets across the top eight markets in India—conducted by the global real estate consultancy.

“High streets are the barometer of the city’s worth on an economic platform,” says Shishir Baijal, Chairman & MD of Knight Frank India. He adds that a good high street is located close to both residential and commercial hubs. Five other key performance indicators—public transport, parking, store visibility, average trading densities and

Flying High

Bengaluru, the Silicon Valley of India, is now the high-street shopping capital of the country too

BY VIDYA S.

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